

Dakosaurus

DACK-oh-SORE-us

- **When** 165–140 million years ago (Late Jurassic to Early Cretaceous)
- **Fossil location** Worldwide
- **Habitat** Shallow seas
- **Length** 15 ft (4–5 m)
- **Diet** Fish, squid, and marine reptiles

Dakosaurus was a fierce marine predator. With a skull like that of a carnivorous dinosaur and large, jagged teeth, it had a powerful bite that could slice through the flesh of other marine reptiles and crunch the shells of ammonites. Its legs had become paddles that helped it steer as its fishlike tail propelled it through the water. It could chase and overcome animals much bigger than itself.



Simosuchus

SIGH-moe-SOO-kuss

- **When** 70 million years ago (Late Cretaceous)
- **Fossil location** Madagascar
- **Habitat** Forests
- **Length** 4 ft (1.2 m)
- **Diet** Plants, maybe some insects

Simosuchus was an unusual crocodylomorph because it had a short skull and blunt face. In fact, its name means “pug-nosed

crocodile.” Even more unusually, this reptile’s teeth show that it was probably a vegetarian that occasionally ate insects. New research suggests that its tail may have been much shorter than that shown in the illustration below.



Deinosuchus

DIE-no-SOO-kuss

- **When** 70–65 million years ago (Late Cretaceous)
- **Fossil location** USA, Mexico
- **Habitat** Swamps
- **Length** 33 ft (10 m)
- **Diet** Fish, medium to large dinosaurs

Deinosuchus was one of the largest prehistoric alligators, nearly five times bigger and heavier than any found today. This alligator may have

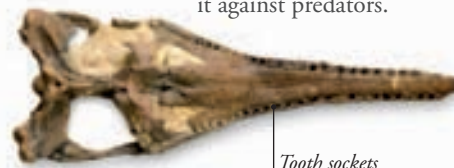
preyed on dinosaurs as big as itself—fossils of certain tyrannosaurs show *Deinosuchus* bite marks. It may have hunted by waiting patiently at the water’s edge to pounce on passing fish, marine reptiles, or land animals. Small victims were swallowed whole. Larger prey were ripped apart into bite-sized chunks.

Steneosaurus

STEN-ee-oh-SORE-us

- **When** 200–145 million years ago (Early Jurassic to Early Cretaceous)
- **Fossil location** Europe, Africa
- **Habitat** Estuaries and coastal waters
- **Length** 3–13 ft (1–4 m)
- **Diet** Fish

Steneosaurus was probably an estuary-living crocodylomorph that ventured out onto land to lay its eggs. Although its long body was adapted for swimming, its limbs had not changed into flippers. It had a thin snout full of sharp teeth for eating fish, and its body was heavily armored to protect it against predators.



Long, powerful jaws with large, sharp teeth



▲ **UNDERWATER TERROR**
Deinosuchus killed its prey as modern alligators do—by dragging its victims underwater and drowning them.